

The Next Chapter for Independent Accounting Firms

For owners considering the future of their practice.



Whether retirement is one year away or ten years away, many firm owners eventually face the same question:

"What happens to my clients, employees, and the relationships I've spent years building when I'm ready for the next chapter?"

I believe the best transitions begin long before a transaction is necessary. My goal is to build relationships with firm owners before a transition becomes urgent and, when the fit is right, continue serving the clients, employees, and community that make the firm valuable.

A Different Kind of Buyer

➡ ✓ Long-Term
Ownership
My goal is to
own and
operate a firm
for decades,
not flip it.

➡ ✓ Seller
Financing
Friendly
Open to
structures
that allow
owners to
transition on
their timeline.

➡ ✓ Stewardship
Mindset
The goal is
not simply to
buy a
practice. The
goal is to
continue
serving
clients,
supporting
employees,
and building
on what
already
works.

Accounting firms are built on trust. For many owners, the business represents decades of relationships with clients, employees, and the community. The right transition is about more than valuation and deal terms. It is about finding someone who genuinely cares about continuing what has been built. I am an accounting graduate, Certified Merger & Acquisition Advisor (CM&AA), and Certified Exit Planning Advisor (CEPA) who is building a long-term future in the accounting profession through practice ownership.

My focus is simple: helping firm owners explore succession options while protecting the people and relationships that make a practice valuable in the first place.

Who I Am



Contact

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Marlik Depp

Accounting Graduate / Future Accounting Firm Owner

If you are thinking about the future of your firm, I believe the right transition is about more than finding a buyer.

It's about finding someone who values the profession, understands the importance of client relationships, and is committed to continuing what you have spent years building.

My goal is to acquire and operate an independent accounting firm, not simply as an investment, but as a long-term commitment to the clients, employees, and relationships that make the firm successful.

Whether that conversation happens today or years from now, I believe successful transitions begin with trust, shared values, and a genuine interest in preserving what makes a firm special.

Education & Professional Credentials



Accounting Degree (BSBAA)

Bachelor of Science in Business Administration, Accounting

Coursework focused on financial accounting, taxation, auditing, financial statement analysis, and business operations.



Certified Merger & Acquisition Advisor (CM&AA)

Completed professional training focused on mergers and acquisitions, transaction structures, valuation concepts, due diligence, and deal execution.



Certified Exit Planning Advisor (CEPA)

Training focused on succession planning, business continuity, value acceleration, and helping owners prepare for future transitions.

Why This Matters To Me

Independent accounting firms are built on trust, relationships, and years of service to clients.

Many owners eventually face an important question:

"What happens to my clients, employees, and firm when I'm ready for the next chapter?"

I chose to pursue accounting, succession planning, and firm acquisitions because I believe independent firms deserve strong successors.

My goal is to learn from firm owners, understand the profession from the ground up, and help carry successful practices into their next phase while preserving the relationships and reputation that made them valuable in the first place.

The future of the profession will require both trusted client relationships and modern systems. I believe the right

transition can protect employees, serve clients well, honor the owner's legacy, and position the firm for long-term success.

Succession should not be viewed as an ending. It should be viewed as a continuation.

Why Owners Reach Out

No Internal Successor



No Internal Successor

Children aren't interested. Employees don't want ownership.



Retirement Planning

The business is valuable but no clear transition exists.



Gradual Ownership Transfer

Owner wants income and continuity while reducing involvement.

How transitions can work

Flexible Transition Structures

Every firm is different. The right structure should fit the owner's goals, timeline, and desired level of involvement.

What Matters most

✓ Clients stay cared for

✓ Employees have
stability

✓ Relationships are
preserved

✓ Transition happens on your timeline

You get paid while you step back, on
a timeline you control

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